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UAE BANS SOCIAL MEDIA FOR CHILDREN UNDER 15

Cabinet issues resolution regulating children's access to social media platforms

DUBAI
BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

The UAE Cabinet has issued a resolution regulating children's access to social media platforms and set the minimum age for social media use at 15 years.

The resolution allows social media platforms to progressively implement the new standards through a transitional period of up to 12 months, in coordination with the relevant authorities,

ensuring technical and regulatory readiness, the government announced yesterday.

The resolution comes amid the growing use of social media platforms by children and the increasing digital challenges and risks associated with such use, including exposure to inappropriate content, unsafe interactions, the collection of personal data, and patterns of excessive usage.

This necessitates the development of an integrated national framework that enables children to benefit from technology

while ensuring their protection in the digital environment.

As per the resolution, children under the age of 15 are prohibited from creating or using personal accounts on social media platforms and shall not be permitted to access their full features.

Regulated and safe access

Children between the ages of 15 and 16 must be provided with regulated and safe access to platforms subject to age-appropriate content classification, restricted interaction, regulated

usage time, and parental controls. Platforms are required to implement accurate and reliable age verification mechanisms. Platforms are also required to monitor non-compliant accounts and take immediate action to enforce compliance, the resolution states.

The resolution applies to all social media platforms that enable users to create accounts or personal profiles, engage in social interaction, publish or share content, or that rely on algorithmic systems to display, rank, or recommend content, whether

free or paid. It applies to all platforms whose services are available within the UAE or are directed at users in the country.

According to the resolution, parental consent shall not constitute a valid exemption from the prohibitions or restrictions set out in the resolution.

No personal data usage

The resolution also prohibits the use or processing of children's personal data for commercial purposes based on the tracking of their digital activities.

Caregivers are responsible for actively supervising their child's permitted digital activity and promoting awareness of safe and responsible online practices, the resolution states. Therefore, caregivers are obliged to supervise their children online and educate them about safe internet use.

The resolution also provides families with a clear framework and practical tools to help guide children toward more responsible and mindful digital engagement.

SEE ALSO P3

Record QS rankings for UAE universities

DUBAI
BY ZAINAB HUSAIN
Features Writer

For the first time, a UAE institution has broken into the global top 150. Khalifa University climbed from 177th to 147th in the QS World University Rankings 2027, released yesterday, a landmark result for the country's higher education sector. Overall, nine of the UAE's 12 ranked universities improved their positions this year, while three dropped.

The University of Sharjah has entered the top 300 for the first time, and Ajman University has risen into the top 400, further signs of the system's broad-based progress.

Top 8 performances

■ **Khalifa University:** 147th (record high, up from 177th); Ranks 87th for Citations per Faculty and 12th for International Faculty.

■ **United Arab Emirates University:** 217th (record high); Among the top 300 for a seventh consecutive year. Ranked 23rd for International Faculty and 79th for Employment Outcomes.

■ **American University of Sharjah:** 258th (record high); In the top 300 for the second consecutive year. Ranked 5th for International Faculty and 14th for International Students.

■ **University of Sharjah:** 299th (first-ever top-300 entry); Ranked 10th for International Faculty and 199th for Citations per Faculty — second only to Khalifa University in the UAE in that area.

■ **Abu Dhabi University:** 348th (record high). Entered the top 400 for the first time last year and has advanced further.

■ **Ajman University:** 397th (first-ever top-400 entry); Debuted in 2019 at the 801–1000 band.

■ **Zayed University:** 588th (record high); First entered the rankings in 2019 at 701–750.

■ **University of Dubai:** Debuted in 2023, has also risen to a record high this year.



AFP

TRUMP SIGNS IRAN TREATY AT VERSAILLES

■ US President Donald Trump, flanked by France's President Emmanuel Macron (right), his wife Brigitte Macron, US Secretary of State Marco Rubio and France's Foreign Affairs Minister Jean-Noel Barrot, during the signing of a deal with Iran to end the Middle East war, inside Chateau de Versailles, in Versailles on Wednesday.

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UAE ranks 1st in economic performance, 5th in overall competitiveness globally

Nation among top 10 in 118 indicators in IMD World Competitiveness Yearbook 2026

DUBAI
BY KHITAM ALAMIR
Chief News Editor

The UAE strengthened its standing among the world's most competitive nations, placing fifth globally in the IMD World Competitiveness Yearbook 2026, while also ranking No 1 in economic performance.

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, said the achievement reflects the country's steady progress under the leadership of President His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan. "Under the

LEADING THE WAY



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indicators in which the UAE claimed first place globally

leadership of Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed, the UAE continues to affirm its place among the world's most competitive nations," Sheikh Mohammed said. He noted that the country ranked

UAE tops in bureaucracy, adaptability of government policies, employment, international experience, national culture, value systems, air transport quality

2nd in citizen trust in AI, new business creation, women's representation in parliament, city management

3rd in national image and branding, access to AI, tourism revenues, exports of goods, energy infrastructure

first globally in economic performance and led 21 indicators, while placing among the world's top five in 67 measures.

According to the IMD World Competitiveness Yearbook 2026,

published by the World Competitiveness Centre at the International Institute for Management Development in Lausanne, Switzerland, the UAE ranked among the top 10 countries in 118 indicators. The country claimed first place in 21 indicators, including bureaucracy, adaptability of government policies, employment, international experience, national culture, value systems and air transport quality.

It ranked second globally in citizen trust in artificial intelligence, new business creation, women's representation in parliament and city management. The UAE also secured third place in areas such as national image and branding, access to artificial intelligence, tourism revenues, exports of goods and energy infrastructure. It placed fourth in government efficiency, private sector investment in AI, and legal and regulatory frameworks.

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